

Executive Briefing Document: FIFA World Cup Details

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

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The FIFA World Cup is the premier international men's football tournament held every four years since 1930, organized by FIFA. The tournament features national teams competing for the Jules Rimet Cup, with an expansion from 32 to 48 teams starting in 2026.

2. KEY ATTENDEE BACKGROUND

- **FIFA Officials:** Representatives from FIFA, the global governing body of football, responsible for tournament organization and regulation.
- **National Football Association Delegates:** Officials from various national teams that have historically competed or will compete in the World Cup.
- **Event Organizers and Sponsors:** Stakeholders involved in logistics, marketing, and commercial partnerships related to the World Cup.

3. RECENT DEVELOPMENTS

- The 2022 World Cup marked Argentina's third championship title, achieved by defeating France in the final.
- To date, 22 final tournaments have been held with 80 national teams having participated.
- Starting with the 2026 World Cup, the tournament will expand to include 48 teams, up from the previous 32.

4. KEY DISCUSSION POINTS

- Strategic implications and operational challenges of expanding the tournament to 48 teams in 2026.
- Historical significance and legacy of the FIFA World Cup, including the origins of the Jules Rimet Cup.
- Analysis of competitive dynamics given multiple title winners: Germany and Italy (4 titles each), Argentina (3), France and Uruguay (2 each), England and Spain (1 each).
- Opportunities for enhancing global engagement and commercial growth through expanded participation.
- Considerations for maintaining tournament quality and scheduling with increased team numbers.

5. POTENTIAL QUESTIONS

- How will the expansion to 48 teams impact tournament logistics and scheduling?
- What measures are being taken to preserve the prestige and competitive balance of the World Cup with more participants?
- How does FIFA plan to leverage the tournament's historical legacy in marketing and fan engagement?

6. ACTION ITEMS

- Review and assess operational plans for the 2026 World Cup expansion to 48 teams.
- Develop communication materials highlighting the tournament's history and recent champions for stakeholder engagement.
- Coordinate with national associations and sponsors to align on expectations and opportunities arising from the expanded format.